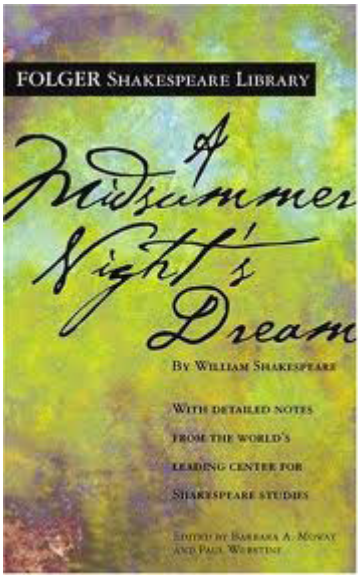
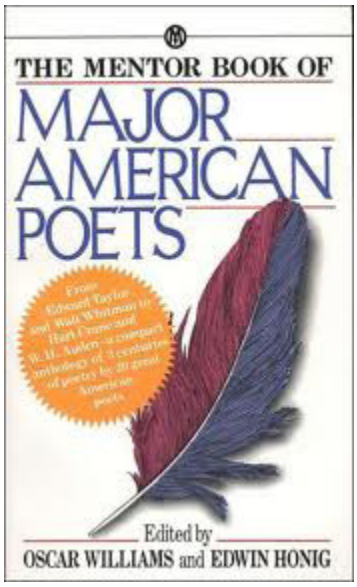
UNIVERSITY INTERSCHOLASTIC LEAGUE

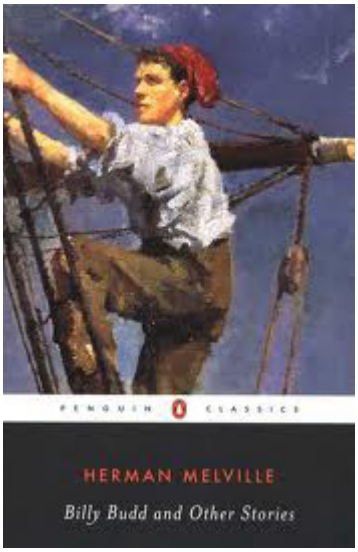
Making a World of Difference

Literary Criticism

Invitational A • 2012







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University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest • Invitational A • 2012

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1. The character directly opposed to the chief character of a literary work is called the

   A) agroikos.
   B) antagonist.
   C) braggadocio.
   D) eiron.
   E) protagonist.

2. The revival of emotional religion during the first half of the eighteenth century in America is known as

   A) Dandyism.
   B) the Great Awakening.
   C) the Harlem Renaissance.
   D) Philistinism.
   E) Transcendentalism.

3. The three-time recipient of the Pulitzer Prize for Poetry (1922, 1925, 1928), the author of *Tristram* and *The Man Who Died Twice*, is

   A) W. H. Auden.
   B) William Rose Benét.
   C) Mark Van Doren.
   D) Edwin Arlington Robinson.
   E) Robert Penn Warren.

4. Originating in the New York City area immediately after the First World War, the first major, self-conscious literary movement of African American writers is known as the

   A) Agraians.
   B) Angry Young Men.
   C) Black Mountain Group.
   D) Fugitives.
   E) Harlem Renaissance.

5. A central idea that in nonfiction prose is recognized as the general topic and in fiction, poetry, and drama is considered the abstract concept made concrete through representation is a(n)

   A) climax.
   B) *in medias res*.
   C) motif.
   D) theme.
   E) thesis.

6. Not among the *ages* in the English literary canon encompassed by the Renaissance Period is the

   A) Augustan Age.
   B) Caroline Age.
   C) Commonwealth Interregnum.
   D) Elizabethan Age.
   E) Jacobean Age.

7. The recipient of the 2004 Pulitzer Prize for Drama for *I Am My Own Wife* is

   A) Edward Albee.
   B) David Auburn.
   C) Jonathan Larson.
   D) Neil Simon.
   E) Doug Wright.

8. An analogy identifying one object with another and ascribing to the first object one or more of the qualities of the second is called (a)

   A) conceit.
   B) metaphor.
   C) metonymy.
   D) simile.
   E) synecdoche.

9. The period in English literature between 1100 and 1350, which is also often called the Early Middle English Period and is frequently dated from the Conquest in 1066, is known as the

   A) Anglo-Norman Period.
   B) Anglo-Saxon Period.
   C) Middle English Period.
   D) Old English Period.
   E) Renaissance Period.

10. The type of lyric poem that is characterized by its single, unified strain of exalted feeling and style, by its single purpose, and by its dealing with one theme is the

    A) aubade.
    B) elegy.
    C) hymn.
    D) limerick.
    E) ode.

11. The group of American writers, including Ida Tarbell, Lincoln Steffens, and Upton Sinclair, who between 1902 and 1911 worked to expose the dishonest methods and unscrupulous motives in big business and in city, state, and national government is

A) the Agrarians.
B) The Fugitives.
C) the Hartford Wits.
D) the Lost Generation.
E) the Muckrakers.

12. The twentieth-century American author of *The Sun Also Rises*, *A Moveable Feast*, *Garden of Eden, Islands in the Stream*, *For Whom the Bell Tolls*, *A Farewell to Arms*, *The Old Man and the Sea*, and the short story "The Short Happy Life of Francis Macomber" is

A) Ernest Hemingway.
B) Norman Mailer.
C) Walker Percy.
D) John Steinbeck.
E) John Updike.

13. The final unraveling, or unknotting, of a plot, the solution of a mystery, or an explanation or outcome of a narrative or drama is the

A) climax.
B) *dénouement*.
C) epiphany.
D) peripety.
E) recalcitrance.

14. The form of verse to be sung or recited and characterized by its presentation of a dramatic or exciting episode in simple narrative form is the

A) antiphon.
B) ballad.
C) madrigal.
D) rondeau.
E) round.

15. The author of *All the Pretty Horses* and *No Country for Old Men* and the recipient of the 2007 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction for *The Road* is

A) Norman Mailer.
B) Cormac McCarthy.
C) Larry McMurtry.
D) N. Scott Momaday.
E) Toni Morrison.

16. The genre of novel dominated by social customs, conventions, and habits of a particular social class, including the novels of Edith Wharton, John P. Marquand, Edward Higgins, and Elmore Leonard, is the

A) novel of character.
B) novel of incident.
C) novel of manners.
D) novel of sensibility.
E) novel of the soil.

17. The group of writers that includes F. Scott Fitzgerald, Erich Maria Remarque, and Ernest Hemingway, who were born around 1900, some serving in WWI, and who also reacted against certain tendencies of older writers in the 1920s, is known as the

A) Agrarians.
B) Fugitives.
C) Hartford Wits.
D) Lost Generation.
E) Pre-Raphaelites.

18. Not a type of rhyme denoting the relationship between or among accented words or syllables constituting end rhyme is

A) compound rhyme.
B) eye rhyme.
C) identical rhyme.
D) leonine rhyme.
E) masculine rhyme.

19. The common English verse triple-syllable foot consisting of one accented syllable followed by two unaccented syllables is the

A) anapest.
B) antibacchius.
C) dactyl.
D) iamb.
E) pyrrhic.

20. The British novelist and playwright and author of *The Lord of the Flies* and the recipient of the 1983 Nobel Prize for Literature is

A) William Golding.
B) Rudyard Kipling.
C) Harold Pinter.
D) Bertrand A. W. Russell.
E) George Bernard Shaw.

21. A speech delivered while the speaker is alone and calculated to inform the audience of what is passing through the character's mind is known as a(n)

A) apostrophe.
B) aside.
C) dramatic monologue.
D) harangue.
E) soliloquy.

22. The device by which a work presents material that occurred prior to the opening scene of a work is

A) digression.
B) elaboration.
C) flashback.
D) foreshadowing.
E) prolepsis.

23. Drama that presents a view of the ridiculousness and ludicrousness of the human condition through its abandonment of the usual or rational devices and by its use of nonrealistic form is known as

A) *reductio ad absurdum*.
B) Theater of Cruelty.
C) Theater of the Absurd.
D) tragedy of blood.
E) tragicomedy.

24. The nineteenth-century British author of novels of manners including *Sense and Sensibility*, *Pride and Prejudice*, *Mansfield Park*, *Northanger Abbey*, *Persuasion*, and *Emma* is

A) Jane Austen.
B) Charlotte Brontë.
C) Emily Brontë.
D) Elizabeth Barrett Browning.
E) George Eliot.

25. The philosophical movement originating in Europe and reaching the United States during the nineteenth century that features a reliance on both intuition and the conscience in artistic thought is

A) Existentialism.
B) Philistinism.
C) Pictorialism.
D) Transcendentalism.
E) Unitarianism.

26. The nine goddesses represented as presiding over the various departments of art and science are known as the

A) Furies.
B) Graces.
C) Humors.
D) Muses.
E) Nine Worthies.

27. The recipient of the 1961 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction for her novel *To Kill a Mockingbird* is

A) Shirley Ann Grau.
B) Harper Lee.
C) Katherine Anne Porter.
D) Carol Shields.
E) Eudora Welty.

28. The term applying to a group of mid-nineteenth-century poets whose verse reflects discontent and unrest and whose poetry is marked by jerkiness and strained emphasis is

A) Cockney School.
B) Fleshy School of Poetry.
C) Martian School.
D) Satanic School.
E) Spasmodic School.

29. Not to be found among a group of authors who might have gathered to discuss the extent to which James Joyce influenced twentieth-century literature is

A) Charles Dickens.
B) Graham Greene.
C) Doris Lessing.
D) Salman Rushdie.
E) Muriel Spark.

30. The figure of speech in which someone (usually, but not always absent), some abstract quality, or a nonexistent personage, is directly addressed as though present is

A) anthropomorphism.
B) apostrophe.
C) personification.
D) prosopopoeia.
E) rhetorical accent.

Part 2: The UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

Items 31-37 are associated with William Shakespeare's *A Midsummer Night's Dream*.
Items 38-45 are associated with Herman Melville's *Billy Budd, Sailor, An Inside Narrative*.
Items 46-50 are associated with Marianne Moore's poetry (selected).

31. In Shakespeare's *Midsummer Night's Dream* interest in a stolen Indian boy defines the interaction between

A) Helena and Lysander.
B) Hermia and Demetrius.
C) Hermia and Lysander.
D) Hippolyta and Theseus.
E) Titania and Oberon.

32. Accused by Egeus of "bewitch[ing] the bosom of [his] child" is

A) Demetrius.
B) Lysander.
C) Oberon.
D) Philostrate.
E) Theseus.

33. Not one of the rude mechanicals who are practicing a play in the forest outside Athens is

A) Nick Bottom.
B) Francis Flute.
C) Robin Goodfellow.
D) Tom Snout.
E) Robin Starveling.

34. The "peril of Athenian law" to which Lysander refers in Act 4 directly threatens

A) Helena.
B) Hermia.
C) Hippolyta.
D) Thisbe.
E) Titania.

35. Bottom's addressing the Moon to "thank [her] for [her] sunny beams / [. . .] for shining so bright" is an example of

A) apostrophe.
B) an aside.
C) braggadocio.
D) personification.
E) reification.

36. The part of the lion in the mechanicals' rendition of *Pyramus and Thisbe* is played by

A) Flute the bellows-mender.
B) Nick the weaver.
C) Quince the carpenter.
D) Snout the tinker.
E) Snug the joiner.

37. In Act 5 Theseus declares, "'Tis almost fairy time," which are the hours between

A) Aurora's arrival and noon.
B) dawn and twilight.
C) evening and vespers.
D) midnight and dawn.
E) twilight and midnight.

38. The martial conflict that serves as a backdrop to the tension throughout Melville's *Billy Budd* is

A) the American Civil War.
B) the English Civil War.
C) the French Revolution.
D) the Russian Revolution.
E) the Spanish Civil War.

39. The person who always, according to the handsome sailor, has "a pleasant word" for Billy is

A) Claggart.
B) the Dansker.
C) Ratcliffe.
D) Squeak.
E) Vere.

40. The phrase "wholly under canvas," which describes the British naval fleet, refers to a time in history when

A) artists painted mainly oceanscapes.
B) naval vessels were covered at night.
C) no steamships plied the oceans.
D) portraits of ships' captains were popular.
E) sailors wore clothes made from hemp.

41. The relationship between Billy and Vere is likened by Melville's narrator to the relationship between Isaac and Abraham, which constitutes a

A) biblical allusion.
B) classical allusion.
C) Homeric epithet.
D) Homeric simile.
E) prolepsis.

42. The connection between himself and Captain Vere that the narrator implies early in his story is the marked tendency to rely on

A) allusions while "illustrating [. . .] any point."
B) archaic vocabulary to impress the Dansker.
C) litotes to emphasize a point.
D) oxymorons to describe the French.
E) slang to describe the members of the crew.

43. Billy Budd's last words were uttered in

A) condemnation of Claggart.
B) condemnation of Vere.
C) defiance of the Articles of War.
D) recognition of Vere.
E) tribute to the Dansker.

44. Billy Budd brings about the demise of his superior with one blow to the

A) chest.
B) forehead.
C) kidney.
D) neck.
E) stomach.

45. "Jemmy Legs" is the nickname given by the crew of the *Bellipotent* to

A) Billy.
B) Claggart.
C) the Dansker.
D) Graveling.
E) Vere.

Items 46-49 refer to Marianne Moore's

To a Snail

If "compression is the first grace of style,"
you have it. Contractility is a virtue
as modesty is a virtue.
It is not the acquisition of any one thing
that is able to adorn,
or the incidental quality that occurs
as a concomitant of something well said,
that we value in style,
but the principle that is hid:
in the absence of feet, "a method of conclusions,"
"a knowledge of principles,"
in the curious phenomenon of your occipital horn.

46. The classical Greek orator from whom Marianne Moore borrows the essence of the first line of her poem "To a Snail" is

A) Cicero of Rome.
B) Demetrius of Phalerum.
C) Demosthenes of Athens.
D) Isocrates of Athens.
E) Jesus of Nazareth.

47. Moore's "To a Snail" addresses what the poet argues is an important characteristic of

A) good writing.
B) incidental phenomena.
C) pseudopodia locomotion.
D) a snail's mobility.
E) virtuous zoology.

48. The figure of speech upon which the poem's first comparison depends is the

A) hyperbole.
B) metaphor.
C) metonymy.
D) simile.
E) zeugma.

49. The literal reference in line 10's "absence of feet" is to the

A) grace of style.
B) method of conclusion.
C) poem's meter.
D) pseudopod's antennae.
E) snail's anatomy.

Item 50 refers to Marianne Moore's

No Swan So Fine

"No water so still as the
  dead fountains of Versailles." No swan,
with swart blind look askance
and gondoliering legs, so fine
  as the chintz china one with fawn-
brown eyes and toothed gold
collar on to show whose bird it was.

Lodged in the Louis Fifteenth
  candelabrum-tree of cockscomb-
tinted buttons, dahlias,
sea urchins, and everlastings,
  it perches on the branching foam
of polished sculptured
flowers—at ease and tall. The king is dead.

50. Overwhelmingly, the imagery in Marianne Moore's "No Swan So Fine" is

A) auditory.
B) gustatory.
C) olfactory.
D) tactile.
E) visual.

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism
15 items (2 points each)

Items 51-54 refer to William Wordsworth's

It Is a Beauteous Evening

It is a beauteous evening, calm and free,
The holy time is quiet as a Nun
Breathless with adoration; the broad sun
Is sinking down in its tranquillity;
The gentleness of heaven broods o'er the Sea;
Listen! the mighty Being is awake,
And doth with his eternal motion make
A sound like thunder—everlastingly.
Dear Child! dear Girl! that walkest with me here,
If thou appear untouched by solemn thought,
Thy nature is not therefore less divine;
Thou liest in Abraham's bosom all the year:
And worshipp'st at the Temple's inner shrine,
God being with thee when we know it not.

51. The form of Wordsworth's poem approaches the

A) caudate sonnet.
B) Miltonic sonnet.
C) Petrarchan sonnet.
D) Shakespearian sonnet.
E) Spenserian sonnet.

52. The imagery in the first four lines of Wordsworth's sonnet depends on a

A) hyperbole.
B) metaphor.
C) particular rhyme.
D) simile.
E) symbol.

53. The poem's basic meter is

A) iambic pentameter.
B) iambic tetrameter.
C) spondaic pentameter.
D) trochaic pentameter.
E) trochaic tetrameter.

54. The reference to Abraham's bosom in line 12 constitutes a(n)

A) allusion.
B) double entendre.
C) hyperbole.
D) paradox.
E) simile.

Items 55-58 refer to Robert Graves's

The Persian Version

Truth-loving Persians do not dwell upon
The trivial skirmish fought near Marathon.
As for the Greek theatrical tradition
Which represents that summer's expedition
Not as a mere reconnaisance in force
By three brigades of foot and one of horse
(Their left flank covered by some obsolete
Light craft detached from the main Persian fleet)
But as a grandiose, ill-starred attempt
To conquer Greece—they treat it with contempt;
And only incidentally refute
Major Greek claims, by stressing what repute
The Persian monarch and the Persian nation
Won by this salutary demonstration:
Despite a strong defence and adverse weather
All arms combined magnificently together.

55. The title of Graves's poem establishes the poem's

A) form.
B) length.
C) meter.
D) setting.
E) tone.

56. The extra syllable in lines 3, 4, and 13-16 is a characteristic of

A) anacrusis.
B) catalexis.
C) the feminine ending.
D) the masculine ending.
E) truncation.

57. The purpose of the word *theatrical* in line 3 is to suggest the Greeks' tendency to

A) canonize.
B) fight with words.
C) hyperbolize.
D) wear buskins.
E) wear masks.

58. The poem can be recognized as a comment on the Persian rhetorical disposition to shape and control the interpretation of an historical event, an effort usually called

A) kitsch.
B) pastiche.
C) propaganda.
D) spin.
E) stunt.

Items 59-63 refer to Marge Piercy's

What's That Smell in the Kitchen?

All over America women are burning dinners.
It's lamb chops in Peoria; it's haddock
in Providence; it's steak in Chicago;
tofu delight in Big Sur; red
rice and beans in Dallas.
All over America women are burning
food they're supposed to bring with calico
smile on platters glittering like wax.
Anger sputters in her brainpan, confined
but spewing out missiles of hot fat.
Carbonized despair presses like a clinker
from a barbecue against the back of her eyes.
If she wants to grill anything, it's
her husband over a slow fire
If she wants to serve him anything
it's a dead rat with a bomb in its belly
ticking like the heart of an insomniac.
Her life is cooked and digested,
nothing but leftovers in Tupperware.
Look, she says, once I was roast duck
on your platter with parsley but now I am Spam.
Burning dinner is not incompetence but war.

59. The tone of Piercy's "What's That Smell in the Kitchen" is

A) compassionately threatening.
B) humorously apathetic.
C) lovingly hurtful.
D) sympathetically wrathful.
E) painfully sarcastic.

60. The "calico smile" (lines 7-8) suggests that true feelings are being

A) burned.
B) carbonized.
C) hidden.
D) melted.
E) sewn.

61. The simile in lines 16-17, "it's a dead rat with a bomb in its belly / ticking like the heart of an insomniac" is doubly forceful because it suggests that

A) insomniacs suffer from food poisoning.
B) dead rats are gunpowder flavored.
C) the problem is always on women's minds.
D) women can serve anything.
E) women cannot cook anything.

62. Piercy's choice of specific foods (lines 2-5) to represent particular customs and manners is a characteristic of

A) cynicism.
B) decadence.
C) Epicureanism.
D) regionalism.
E) spatialism.

63. Ultimately, the imagery and the diction that characterize Piercy's poem suggest that the burning of food should be understood as a statement of

A) culinary incompetence.
B) gustatory excess.
C) marital rebellion.
D) nutritive nonsense.
E) servile acceptance.

Items 64-65 refer to Robinson Jeffers's

Fire on the Hills

The deer were bounding like blown leaves
Under the smoke in front the roaring wave of the brush-fire;
I thought of the smaller lives that were caught.
Beauty is not always lovely; the fire was beautiful, the terror
Of the deer was beautiful; and when I returned
Down the back slopes after the fire had gone by, an eagle
Was perched on the jag of a burnt pine,
Insolent and gorged, cloaked in the folded storms of his shoulders
He had come from far off for the good hunting
With fire for his beater to drive the game; the sky was merciless
Blue, and the hills merciless black,
The sombre-feathered great bird sleepily merciless between them.
I thought, painfully, but the whole mind,
The destruction that brings an eagle from heaven is better than mercy.

64. Jeffers's observation in "Fire on the Hills" that "[b]eauty is not always lovely" (line 4) is a(n)

A) antiphrasis.
B) equivoque.
C) hyperbole.
D) oxymoron.
E) paradox.

65. The description of the eagle as "cloaked in the folded storms of his shoulders" (8) is built on (a)

A) black humor.
B) hiatus.
C) kenning.
D) metaphor.
E) personification.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay (required)

Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie.

Note well: Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.

Three sheets of paper have been provided for this essay; your written response should reflect the *Handbook*'s notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than a few sentences.

Read Marianne Moore's "To an Inter-mural Rat," and discuss her comparison—her jump—from "inter-mural rat" to men found in a "parenthesis of wit."

To an Inter-mural Rat*

* **(between walls)**

You make me think of many men
Once met, to be forgot again
Or merely resurrected
In a parenthesis of wit
That found them hastening through it
Too brisk to be inspected.

Marianne Moore

University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest
Invitational A • 2012
KEY

Page numbers are those associated with the *Handbook* 11e, the Penguin 1986 edition of *Budd*, and the Folger edition of *MND*.

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History

30 items (1 point each)

1.	B	32	11.	E	356	21.	E	518
2.	B	52	12.	A		22.	C	231
3.	D	662	13.	B	156	23.	C	2
4.	E	261	14.	B	55	24.	A	
5.	D	551	15.	B	661	25.	D	557
6.	A	198	16.	C	377	26.	D	356
7.	E	665	17.	D	323	27.	B	660
8.	B	340	18.	D	312	28.	E	521
9.	A	29	19.	C	148	29.	A	d. 1870
10.	E	381	20.	A	658	30.	B	40

Part 2: UIL Reading List

20 items (2 points each)

31.	E	2.1.24	38.	C		45.	B	320
32.	B	1.1.28	39.	A	336	46.	B	
33.	C		40.	C	308/291	47.	A	
34.	B	1.1.67-68	41.	A	367	48.	D	514
35.	A	40	42.	A	312	49.	E	
36.	E	1.2.62	43.	D	375	50.	E	
37.	D	5.1.381	44.	B	350			

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism

15 items (2 points each)

51.	C	300	56.	C	226	61.	C	
52.	D	514	57.	C		62.	D	464
53.	A		58.	D	522	63.	C	
54.	A	16	59.	E		64.	E	398
55.	E		60.	C		65.	D	340

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

the degree to which the instructions have been followed,

the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,

the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and

the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

Critical Notes on Marianne Moore's "The Intra-mural Rat"

Literary concepts that MIGHT be used by the contestant in a discussion of these poems include

apostrophe,
comparison,
conceit,
connection,
imagery,
rhyme, and
wit.

The contestant should recognize the commonality characterizing much of Marianne Moore's poetry, especially the selections that we are reading. Moore makes unexpected connections between, fairly frequently, the natural world and something else, in this case a rat and "many men." The tie-breaking essays might simply address this comparison, though some attention should be paid to the "interesting" aspect(s) of comparing men the persona has known to a rat scurrying through a wall.

The young writer might suggest that the comparison of rat and man (the unexpected jump) is not so extraordinary; however, the intent of the persona's comparison of "many men" to a rat between the walls is to note that her own awareness of them (both the rat and the men) is short lived—either they are beyond her immediate interest, or they are not around long enough to be a real bother.

The thrust of the persona's observation of her (?) own reaction is to minimize the many men's importance: as is a rat's presence between the walls of a house a distraction, so too the presence of these many men within the walls of her life.

The strength of the comparison, what might be considered the conceit, is the likening of the walls within which a rat might scurry to the framing suggested by the two halves of a parenthesis (within which she notes the men hastening), the conceit itself representative of her wit (with which she denigrates the men she has met).